

POLICY & CODE OF CONDUCT

Professional Bartending Training Course

United Kingdom

Version 2.0 | Effective Date: _____

This document constitutes a legally binding agreement between the course provider and each enrolled participant. All participants must read this document in full and sign the acknowledgement at Section 15 before commencing training. This policy is reviewed annually and is subject to change. The most current version supersedes all previous editions.

1. Introduction & Purpose

This Policy and Code of Conduct sets out the standards of behaviour, safety obligations, legal responsibilities, and professional expectations required of all participants enrolled on this bartending training course. It has been prepared in accordance with applicable UK legislation and industry best practice.

The course provider is committed to delivering a safe, inclusive, and professionally enriching learning environment. Compliance with this policy is mandatory for all learners. Failure to comply may result in disciplinary action up to and including removal from the course.

2. Eligibility & Legal Compliance

2.1 Age Requirement

In accordance with the Licensing Act 2003 and the Licensing (Scotland) Act 2005:

- All participants must be 18 years of age or older prior to enrolment.
- Valid government-issued photo identification (passport, driving licence, or PASS-accredited proof-of-age card) must be presented at the point of enrolment.
- The course provider reserves the right to verify age at any stage of the programme. Any participant found to have misrepresented their age will be immediately removed from the course and may be reported to relevant authorities.

2.2 Right to Work & Eligibility to Train

Participants are responsible for ensuring they have the legal right to undertake vocational training in the United Kingdom. The course provider is not responsible for verifying immigration status but may be required to report concerns to the Home Office under the Immigration, Asylum and Nationality Act 2006.

2.3 UK Licensing Law

All participants must understand and comply with the following key provisions of UK alcohol licensing law throughout their training and future employment:

- Licensing Act 2003 (England & Wales) / Licensing (Scotland) Act 2005 / Licensing and Registration of Clubs Act (Northern Ireland) 2014 — governing the sale and supply of alcohol.
- The four licensing objectives: prevention of crime and disorder; public safety; prevention of public nuisance; and protection of children from harm.

- Challenge 25 policy: participants must understand how and when to request proof of age and must refuse service where age cannot be confirmed.
- Duty of Refusal: it is a criminal offence under section 141 of the Licensing Act 2003 to sell alcohol to a person who is drunk. Participants must be able to identify signs of intoxication and understand the obligation to refuse service.
- Proxy purchasing: it is an offence to knowingly sell alcohol to an adult for consumption by a minor. Participants must be alert to proxy purchase attempts.
- Permitted development hours and conditions attached to any premises licence under which training may take place.

2.4 Health & Safety Legal Framework

Participants are required to comply with all applicable health and safety legislation while on the training premises, including but not limited to:

- Health and Safety at Work etc. Act 1974 — general duty of care for employees and persons present on premises.
- Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1999 — including awareness of risk assessments.
- Manual Handling Operations Regulations 1992 — safe handling of kegs, crates, and heavy stock.
- Control of Substances Hazardous to Health (COSHH) Regulations 2002 — relating to cleaning chemicals and allergens.
- Reporting of Injuries, Diseases and Dangerous Occurrences Regulations 2013 (RIDDOR) — participants must report all accidents and near-misses immediately.
- Food Safety Act 1990 and Food Hygiene (England) Regulations 2006 — applicable to the preparation of garnishes, mixers, and any food items.

3. Conduct & Professional Behaviour

3.1 Respectful & Inclusive Environment

The course provider is committed to providing an environment free from discrimination, harassment, bullying, and victimisation, in accordance with:

- Equality Act 2010 — which protects individuals from discrimination on the basis of the following protected characteristics: age, disability, gender reassignment, marriage and civil partnership, pregnancy and maternity, race, religion or belief, sex, and sexual orientation.
- Protection from Harassment Act 1997 — which prohibits conduct causing alarm or distress.

Any participant found to have engaged in discriminatory, harassing, or abusive behaviour will face immediate disciplinary action, which may include removal from the course and referral to the police where appropriate.

3.2 Professional Attitude

All participants are expected to conduct themselves in a professional manner at all times. This includes:

- Attending all scheduled sessions punctually and prepared.
- Notifying the course provider in advance if unable to attend, with as much notice as possible.
- Treating instructors, assessors, and fellow learners with courtesy and respect.
- Refraining from disruptive, aggressive, or intimidating behaviour.
- Mobile phones and personal electronic devices must be kept on silent and must not be used during practical training sessions unless explicitly permitted by the instructor. Recording of sessions (audio or visual) is prohibited without prior written consent from the course provider and all individuals involved, in accordance with the UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR) and the Data Protection Act 2018.

3.3 Intoxication & Substance Use Policy

The following rules apply at all times on training premises and at any course-related event:

- Participants must arrive sober and free from the influence of alcohol or any controlled substance.
- Consumption of alcohol prior to or during training sessions is strictly prohibited, except during formally structured tasting exercises that are explicitly led and supervised by a qualified instructor.
- Any participant who appears to be under the influence of alcohol or drugs will be asked to leave the premises immediately and will not be readmitted to that session. Repeated occurrences will result in permanent removal from the course without refund.
- The possession or use of controlled substances on the training premises is a criminal offence under the Misuse of Drugs Act 1971 and will be reported to the police without exception.
- Where a participant is suspected of being under the influence, the course provider reserves the right to request that the participant leaves and, in the interests of safeguarding, to contact an emergency contact or appropriate authority.

4. Alcohol Handling & Tasting Protocol

4.1 Structured Tasting Activities

Tasting exercises form part of the educational curriculum and are governed by the following rules:

- All tasting activities are instructor-led and conducted within the parameters of any premises licence in force.
- Quantities are restricted to small, measured samples and will not exceed recognised industry education standards.
- Participation in tasting exercises is entirely voluntary. No participant shall be penalised, pressured, or disadvantaged for declining to participate.
- Participants must declare in advance if they are pregnant, have a medical condition, are taking medication that may interact with alcohol, or have religious or personal objections to alcohol consumption. Alternative learning arrangements will be provided.
- A participant must not drive a motor vehicle immediately following any tasting session. It is the participant's personal legal responsibility to comply with the Road Traffic Act 1988 and the drink-drive limits prescribed thereunder.

4.2 Responsible Alcohol Handling

- Correct measurement techniques using approved bar measures (jiggers) must be used at all times during training.
- Alcohol must be stored, handled, and disposed of in accordance with the Training Facility's standard operating procedures.
- Participants must not remove alcohol from the training premises under any circumstances.
- Spillages must be cleaned promptly in accordance with hygiene procedures.

5. Allergen Awareness & Dietary Safety

Under Regulation (EU) No 1169/2011 on Food Information to Consumers (retained in UK law post-Brexit) and the Food Information Regulations 2014, participants must be aware of the 14 major allergens that may be present in cocktail ingredients, mixers, and garnishes, including but not limited to:

- Celery, cereals containing gluten (e.g., wheat-based beers), crustaceans, eggs, fish, lupin, milk, molluscs, mustard, peanuts, sesame, soya, sulphur dioxide and sulphites (present in wine and some spirits above 10mg/kg), and tree nuts.

Participants must:

- Declare any known personal allergies to the instructor prior to any handling or tasting activity.
- Never substitute ingredients in training recipes without instructor approval, as this could affect allergen content.
- Handle allergen-containing products with care and clean equipment thoroughly between preparations.

6. Equipment Safety & Hazard Management

6.1 Training on Dangerous Equipment

Participants will receive formal instruction on the safe use of all bar equipment before handling.

Equipment covered includes, but is not limited to:

- Sharp implements: knives, channel knives, zesters, and citrus peelers.
- Glassware: handling, storage, polishing, and managing broken glass.
- Cocktail shakers under pressure, including sealed tin-on-tin and Boston shakers.
- Electrical equipment: blenders, juicers, ice crushers, and carbonation systems.
- Gas canisters: CO₂ systems for soda and cream whippers (N₂O). Note that nitrous oxide canisters used outside of food preparation may constitute possession of a psychoactive substance under the Psychoactive Substances Act 2016. Participants must only use such equipment for its intended culinary purpose.
- Hot equipment: kettles, blowtorches (for garnish and smoking techniques), and induction burners.

6.2 Safety Expectations

- No equipment may be used by a participant until formal instruction has been completed and competency confirmed by the instructor.
- Personal protective equipment (PPE) — including cut-resistant gloves and non-slip footwear — must be worn whenever required by the instructor or risk assessment.
- Broken glass must be reported immediately, isolated, and disposed of using the designated sharps procedure (never bare hands or into general waste).
- Horseplay, misuse of equipment, or deliberate unsafe behaviour will result in immediate removal from the training session and disciplinary action.
- Any accident, injury, or near-miss must be reported to the instructor immediately and recorded in the accident log in accordance with RIDDOR 2013.
- Participants with pre-existing medical conditions (e.g., epilepsy, heart conditions) that may be affected by flashing lights, loud noise, or physical exertion must declare this prior to training.

6.3 Fire Safety

- All participants must be made aware of emergency exits, assembly points, and evacuation procedures at the start of each training day.
- Fire exits must never be obstructed.
- The use of open flames (e.g., blowtorches, flamed citrus peels, smoking guns) must only be performed under direct instructor supervision and in compliance with the Regulatory Reform (Fire Safety) Order 2005.
- Any fire alarm, regardless of whether believed to be a false alarm, must result in the full evacuation of the premises.

7. Hygiene & Personal Presentation

7.1 Food & Hygiene Standards

In accordance with the Food Safety Act 1990 and Food Hygiene (England) Regulations 2006:

- Hands must be washed thoroughly with soap and warm water: before handling any ingredients; after handling raw produce, waste, allergens, or cleaning chemicals; after using the toilet; and after touching the face, hair, or body.
- Hair must be tied back securely when working in the bar area.
- Jewellery should be kept to a minimum — rings (other than a plain wedding band), bracelets, and dangling earrings must be removed before practical sessions.
- Fingernails must be kept short and clean. Nail polish and false nails are not permitted during practical sessions as they present both a hygiene and a contamination risk.
- Appropriate attire is required at all times: closed-toe, non-slip footwear; clean clothing; and any course-issued uniform or apron when directed.

7.2 Illness & Communicable Disease Policy

Under the Food Safety Act 1990 and general duty of care obligations:

- Participants must not attend training if they are experiencing symptoms of a communicable illness, including but not limited to: vomiting, diarrhoea, fever above 38°C, jaundice, or infected skin wounds on the hands or arms.
- Participants who develop symptoms during the training day must inform the instructor immediately and will be required to leave the premises.
- In the event of a diagnosed notifiable disease (as listed under the Health Protection (Notification) Regulations 2010), the participant must not return until they have been cleared by a medical professional.
- The course provider reserves the right to exclude any participant on health grounds where a risk to others is identified.

8. Data Protection & Privacy

The course provider processes personal data in accordance with the UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR) and the Data Protection Act 2018. By enrolling on this course, participants acknowledge the following:

- Personal data (including name, date of birth, contact details, and assessment records) will be collected and processed solely for the administration, delivery, and certification of the course.
- Data will not be sold or passed to third parties for marketing purposes without explicit consent.
- Data may be shared with awarding bodies, regulatory authorities, or emergency services where legally required.
- Participants have the right to access, rectify, or request erasure of their personal data by contacting the course provider in writing.
- CCTV may be in operation on the training premises for security purposes. Participants will be notified of any recording at the start of their first session.
- Photographing or recording other participants without their explicit consent is prohibited and may constitute a breach of data protection law.

9. Safeguarding

Although this course is restricted to adults, the course provider is committed to the welfare of all participants. The following safeguarding principles apply:

- The course provider has a designated Safeguarding Lead who is responsible for managing any concerns relating to the welfare of participants.
- If a participant discloses information suggesting they or another person is at risk of harm, the instructor is required to follow the organisation's safeguarding procedure, which may involve referral to local safeguarding authorities.
- Participants who are concerned about their own welfare or that of another person should speak to any member of the training team in confidence.
- The course provider complies with the safeguarding framework set out in the Care Act 2014 and associated statutory guidance.

10. Facilities, Equipment & Property

10.1 Care of Training Facilities

- Participants must treat all training spaces, tools, glassware, and materials with respect and care.
- Any damage, loss, or malfunction must be reported immediately to the instructor.
- Wilful damage to property may result in the participant being held liable for the cost of repair or replacement.

10.2 Personal Belongings

- Personal belongings are brought onto the premises entirely at the participant's own risk.
- The course provider and venue accept no liability for the loss, theft, or damage of personal property.
- Participants are advised not to bring valuables to training sessions.

11. Assessment, Academic Integrity & Certification

11.1 Assessment Conduct

- All assessments must be completed honestly and independently unless the assessment brief specifies otherwise.
- Cheating, plagiarism, impersonation, or any other form of academic misconduct will result in the immediate disqualification of the relevant assessment and may result in removal from the course.
- Falsifying assessment records, logs, or competency documentation is a serious offence and may be referred to the relevant awarding body.

11.2 Certification & Awarding Bodies

- Where this course leads to a recognised qualification, the awarding body's regulations and code of conduct will apply in addition to this policy.
- Certificates will only be issued upon full completion of all required assessments and payment of any applicable fees.
- The course provider accepts no responsibility for certificates that cannot be issued due to the participant's failure to meet assessment criteria or comply with course policies.

11.3 Feedback & Complaints

- Constructive feedback from participants is actively encouraged and valued.

- Concerns about training delivery, assessment fairness, or the conduct of staff should be raised with the course lead in the first instance.
- If a concern cannot be resolved informally, participants have the right to submit a formal written complaint, which will be handled in accordance with the course provider's complaints procedure.
- If a complaint relates to the awarding body's processes, participants may escalate to the awarding body directly.

12. Attendance, Cancellation & Refund Policy

- A minimum attendance level (as specified in the course handbook) must be met in order to qualify for certification.
- Absences must be communicated to the course provider as early as possible. Missed sessions may not be recoverable, and repeat absences may result in deferral or withdrawal from the course.
- Cancellation by the participant prior to the commencement of training may be subject to the course provider's cancellation and refund policy, which will be provided separately at the point of enrolment.
- The Consumer Contracts (Information, Cancellation and Additional Charges) Regulations 2013 may apply where the course was booked online or at a distance. A 14-day cooling-off period may apply unless training has already commenced.
- The course provider reserves the right to cancel or reschedule sessions due to circumstances beyond its control (including but not limited to instructor illness, venue unavailability, or force majeure events). In such cases, participants will be offered an alternative session or a pro-rata refund.

13. Liability & Insurance

The course provider holds appropriate public liability insurance. Participants are advised of the following:

- The course provider's liability is limited to direct losses resulting from its negligence or breach of statutory duty and does not extend to indirect, consequential, or economic losses.
- Participants undertake training at their own risk, provided that all safety instructions have been duly given and followed.
- Nothing in this policy limits or excludes the course provider's liability for death or personal injury caused by negligence, fraud, or any other matter that cannot be excluded by law.
- Participants are responsible for arranging their own insurance for travel to and from the training venue.

Note: Nothing in this policy is intended to, and shall not, affect the statutory rights of any consumer as provided under the Consumer Rights Act 2015 or any other applicable UK legislation.

14. Disciplinary Procedure

Breaches of this Policy & Code of Conduct will be dealt with in accordance with the following procedure. The course provider reserves the right to apply any stage of the procedure based on the severity of the breach.

- Stage 1 — Informal Verbal Warning: For minor or first-time breaches. The learner will be spoken to privately and the matter recorded informally.
- Stage 2 — Formal Written Warning: For repeated minor breaches or a single more serious breach. The warning will be issued in writing, setting out the nature of the breach and expectations going forward.

- Stage 3 — Suspension from Training: For serious breaches or where a written warning has not resulted in improved conduct. The participant may be suspended pending investigation.
- Stage 4 — Permanent Removal: For gross misconduct (including but not limited to: violence or threats of violence; possession or use of controlled substances; deliberate unsafe use of equipment; serious safeguarding concerns; or persistent non-compliance). Removal will be without refund.

Where a breach of this policy may also constitute a criminal offence, the course provider reserves the right and may have a legal duty to report the matter to the police or other relevant authority.

Participants have the right to appeal any disciplinary decision by notifying the course provider in writing within seven calendar days of receiving written notification of the decision.

15. Acknowledgement & Participant Agreement

By signing this document, you confirm that:

- You have read and understood this Policy & Code of Conduct in full.
- You agree to comply with all terms and conditions set out in this document.
- You understand that failure to comply may result in disciplinary action up to and including removal from the course without refund.
- You consent to the processing of your personal data as described in Section 8 of this policy.
- You confirm that you are 18 years of age or older and have the legal right to undertake training in the United Kingdom.
- You acknowledge that this document, once signed, forms part of your enrolment agreement with the course provider.

Participant Full Name (Print):	On Behalf of Course Provider:
Participant Signature:	Authorised Signatory Signature:
Date:	Date:

For internal use only: Course Provider copy to be retained securely in accordance with UK GDPR data retention policies. Participant copy to be provided upon request.